

THE ARMY MILITARY-CIVILIAN COST SYSTEM (AMCOS) PAY PLAN XWALK METHODOLOGY



CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION (CUI)

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INTRODUCTION

This document provides detail on how the AMCOS Pay Plan Crosswalk application works to associate a given subgroup, pay plan, and level to other types.

METHODOLOGY

WHAT IS DISPLAYED

In order for selections and data to appear within this application there has to be two things:

- 1) A current actual cost – if AMCOS does not have a cost for a given location, pay plan, subgroup, and level combination then it will not appear in the application; current cost is important as it will not show historical costs, only costs for the current release
- 2) A crosswalk – if our crosswalk sources (see sections below) do not provide for an actual path from one scenario to another then you will not see it in this application despite it being available in say AMCOS lite

SUBGROUP CROSSWALK

AMCOS uses the 5 crosswalk sources from ONET Online (<https://www.onetcenter.org/crosswalks.html>). This data allows AMCOS to equate each of the subgroup types shown below to an ONET Standard Occupation Code (SOC) creating a common pivot point.

AMCOS Subgroup types:

- Military Officer/Enlisted: ##α (e.g. 11B)
- Military Warrant Officer: ###α (e.g. 120A)
- Civilian: #####(α) (e.g. 1515)
- Contractor: ##-#### (e.g. 15-2031)

Legend:

= number

α = letter

(α) = optional 5th position, this is rare and only in cases with specific special pay circumstance (e.g. Firefighters)

LEVEL CROSSWALK

AMCOS has four different types of levels, sometimes referred to more generally as just Grade Level. But they each are separate and distinct

- Grade Level (e.g. 0-19): Used for most Civilians and all Military positions
- Pay Band (e.g. 1-5) – used for only select pay plans that are pay banded (e.g. DB)
- Min (1); Average (2); Max (3) (e.g. SES)
- Percentile (e.g. 50th) – used for CCE

Due to the difference in levels, something that might seem intuitively equivalent is not. For example NH2 does not equate to GS2. NH Pay Band 2 is actually linked to the GS Grade Level 5 to GS Grade Level 11. In the AMCOS PP Xwalk we do this linking for you based on the source documents outlined below.

- DoDI 1000.01 Table 2 provides for the level cross walk between Military, SES/GS, Wage, and NAF Pay Band. This document constitutes the bulk of the logic AMCOS uses for level cross walking.

- Using the above we are able to add additional pay plans that share equivalency with GS (e.g. GG/GL, etc).
- Pay Plans using Pay Banding that are pegged to GS are also then able to be cross walked (e.g. DB, NH, CY, etc).
- Non-Appropriated fund grade level based pay plans are assumed to be equal to their appropriated fund wage counterparts: WG=NA; WS=NS; and WL=WL (e.g. WG1=NA1)
- AR570 Table 6-3 provides for additional information that is similar to but not as comprehensive as DoDI 1000.01. Therefore, AMCOS observes this information, but it is not used directly in our cross walk.
- Appropriated Fund Operating Manual Subchapter11 provides cross walk information from the main AF Wage Plans (WG/WS/WL) to other Wage plans. For example WS7 = WN1 = WD5.
- We assume that Grade Levels of 0 are equivalent to all other potential grade levels (e.g. AD0 = GS1 through GS15)
- Finally, there is no defined crosswalk between grade levels/pay bands and CCE percentiles (e.g. 50th). Therefore, we use a model which says that any CCE salary that is +/- 20% of a civilian or military salary is equivalent. For example: CCE 50th percentile salary of \$85k is within the above threshold of a GS position making \$100k so we equate the two. This is done on a location specific basis to account for the intricacies of local labor markets. See the Contractor Cost Estimate methodology for more information on where CCE salary data originates from.

BRINGING IT ALL TOGETHER

The above logic, integrated into the Pay Plan Xwalk application, makes life easier by doing all of the tough equivalency work for you. Based on your selection for a given subgroup, pay plan, and level (e.g. 1515 GS-15) AMCOS will return all other: 1) subgroups who are equivalent to 1515 per ONET AND 2) are equivalent to a GS-15 per the various sources and assumptions we use for level equivalency. From there you may download and/or filter the data to further zero in on your target analysis. For further instructions on filtering and using the application's filters and tabs please see the Pay Plan Xwalk Tutorial.

APPENDIX

AMCOS' subgroups consist of Military, Series (discussed below) and SOC (also discussed below). This appendix expands on the explanations of series and SOC provided earlier in this document.

OCCUPATIONAL SERIES

Occupational Series is used to identify General Schedule white-collar and blue-collar occupations. This data is provided by the Office of Personnel Management (OPM). For more information on OPM OCCs, go to the following link: <http://www.opm.gov/policy-data-oversight/classification-qualifications/classifying-general-schedule-positions/#url=Standards>

- **Occupational (OCC) Group:** A major subdivision of the General Schedule, embracing a group of associated or related occupations, e.g., 1500: Mathematics and Statistics Group.
- **Series:** A subdivision of an occupational group consisting of positions similar to a specialized line of work and qualification requirements. Series are designated by a title and number, e.g., 1515: Operations Research Series.
- OCC groups 0000 – 2200 identify the AMCOS GS pay plan.

STANDARD OCCUPATIONAL CLASSIFICATIONS (SOC)

Standard Occupational Classifications (SOC) is used to identify civilian occupations. This data is provided by the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS). For more information on BLS SOC, go to the following link: http://www.bls.gov/oes/current/oes_abo.htm for National, State, Metropolitan, and Nonmetropolitan Area Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates.

- **SOC Major Group** – Is the Standard Occupational Classification (SOC) Major Group and has a unique, six-digit (plus hyphen) numerical identifier for each occupation series.
 - Workers primarily engaged in planning and directing is classified in management occupations in Major Group 11-0000.
 - Duties of these workers may include supervision.
 - Supervisors of workers in Major Groups 13-0000 through 29-0000 usually have work experience and perform activities similar to those of the workers they supervise, and therefore are classified with the workers they supervise.
- **Detailed Occupation** - A minor group SOC with a descriptive title that corresponds to the Major SOC code, e.g., 11-3031: Financial Managers is a subgroup of Major Group 11-0000: Management Occupations.